

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody consists of quarter and half notes, with some phrases spanning across bar lines. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at various points: D-flat major at the beginning, E-flat major, A-flat major, and D-flat major in the first line; D-flat major and G-flat major in the second line; A-flat major, A-flat major with a sus4 extension, and D-flat major in the third line; G-flat major, E-flat major, and F major in the fourth line; and D-flat major with a 9th extension, F major, E-flat major, A-flat major, and D-flat major in the fifth line. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three stanzas of text aligned under the corresponding notes.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.